Xuanbin Yang

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Research Interests

Empirical Asset Pricing; Time-Series Analysis; Nonparametric Statistics; Machine Learning.

Education

Nankai University, School of Finance Sep 2022 – Present
Ph.D. in Finance (Financial Econometrics)
Advisor: Prof. Tingting Cheng.

Monash University, Monash Business School Mar 2026 – Mar 2027
Visiting Ph.D. in Econometrics, Department of Econometrics and Business Statistics
Advisor: Prof. Jiti Gao. Funded by the China Scholarship Council.

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, School of Finance
Sep 2018 – Jun 2022
Bachelor's Degree in Finance, Finance and Artificial Intelligence Experimental Program
GPA: 3.9/4.0; top 3%; Outstanding Graduate.

Research Papers

Published and Forthcoming

1. Economic policy uncertainty and municipal corporate bonds credit spreads: Evidence from China *(with Tingting Cheng, Liping Qiu, Wenya Lv, and Gang Yang)*. ***Finance Research Letters***, 69, 106170, 2024.

Revise and Resubmit

2. Predicting the Predictable: Decomposing and Forecasting Stock Returns in a Data-rich Environment *(with Tingting Cheng and Albert Bo Zhao)*. Resubmitted (First decision: Reject and resubmit) to ***Management Science***.
3. Binary Response Forecasting under a Factor-Augmented Framework *(with Tingting Cheng, Jiachen Cong, and Fei Liu)*. Reject and resubmit at ***Journal of Applied Econometrics***.
4. Market Expectations in the Cross-Section of Leading Present Values *(with Mengmeng Guo and Qiuhua Xu)*. Major revision at ***Journal of Financial Econometrics***.
5. Bootstrap Inference for Present-Value Models with Estimated Factors *(with Tingting Cheng)*. Revise and resubmit at ***Economics Letters***.

Under Review

6. Extracting Predictability: A Time-Varying Factor-Augmented Approach under Mixed Persistence *(with Tingting Cheng, Jiti Gao, and Yayi Yan)*. Under review at ***Journal of Econometrics***.
7. FISTRA: A Financial-Factor-Informed Set Transformer for Learning Tradable Factors from Stock Cross-Sections *(with Tingting Cheng, Fengli Ma, and Yue Zheng)*. Under review at ***AAAI 2027***.

Research Grants and Fellowships

1. National Natural Science Foundation of China General Program (No. 72673089) — Through Dec 2030
   Theory and Applications of Nonlinear High-Dimensional Panel Data Models
   Project participant. Principal investigator: Prof. Tingting Cheng.
2. China Scholarship Council Scholarship for Joint Ph.D. Training — Mar 2026 – Mar 2027
   Monash University, Australia
   Recipient of a 12-month scholarship for visiting doctoral research in econometrics.
3. National Natural Science Foundation of China General Program (No. 72173068) — Jan 2022 – Dec 2025
   Theory and Applications of Varying-Coefficient Factor-Augmented Models in the Big-Data Era
   Project participant. Principal investigator: Prof. Tingting Cheng.

Conference Presentations

All presentations listed below are oral; forthcoming presentations are marked as scheduled.

Oct 2026	23rd Chinese Finance Annual Meeting *Nankai University, Tianjin, China. Scheduled.*
Oct 2026	23rd Annual Conference on Financial Systems Engineering and Risk Management *Southwest Jiaotong University, Chengdu, China. Scheduled.*
Aug 2026	11th Forum on Risk Management and Financial Statistics *Hebei University of Technology, Tianjin, China.* ***Outstanding Paper Award.***
Aug 2026	9th International Conference on Econometrics and Statistics (EcoSta 2026) *Ryukoku University, Kyoto, Japan*
Jul 2026	4th Joint Conference on Statistics and Data Science *Guiyang, Guizhou, China*
Jun 2026	International Workshop on Machine Learning and Applications in Financial Econometrics *Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China*
Dec 2025	6th Workshop on Big Data Econometrics: Theory and Applications — Econometric Modeling and Statistical Learning for Time Series Data *Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China*
Oct 2025	22nd Chinese Finance Annual Meeting *Nanjing University, Nanjing, China*
Jul 2025	2025 International Conference on Econometrics and Statistics (ICES 2025) *Harbin Institute of Technology, Harbin, China.* ***Best Student Oral Presentation Award.***
Dec 2024	40th Anniversary Conference and 2024 Annual Meeting of the National Association of Industrial Statistics Teaching and Research *Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Shanghai, China*
Jul 2024	International Workshop on Financial Econometrics: Applications and Practice *Nankai University, Tianjin, China*
Jun 2024	International Chinese Statistical Association (ICSA) 2024 China Conference *Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China*
May 2024	10th Jingshi Scholars Forum and 5th Tsinghua-Peking-Renmin Graduate Forum in Economics and Management *Renmin University of China, Beijing, China*
Dec 2023	National Academic Forum for Ph.D. Students in Quantitative Economics *Xiamen University, Xiamen, China*

Honors and Awards

- Gongneng Scholarship, Nankai University (five times).
- Special Scholarship for Academic Competitions, Nankai University.
- Outstanding Graduate; Outstanding Student, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship Scholarship; Labor Literacy and Skills Scholarship; Social Work and Volunteer Service Scholarship, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Honorable Mention, COMAP Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial Second Prize, China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial First Prize, Sichuan Provincial College Student FinTech Modeling Competition.
- Provincial Third Prize, Chinese Mathematics Competitions.
- Sichuan Province A-Level Certificate for College Student Comprehensive Quality.

Professional Service and Skills

Referee service: ***Econometric Reviews***; ***Finance Research Letters***; ***Economic Modelling***.
Software: MATLAB; Python; R; Stata; LaTeX.